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俄罗斯需要说出关于一例疫病死亡病例的真相

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正文逐段中英双语对照 / Paragraph-by-Paragraph Bilingual Text

第 1 段 / Paragraph 1

EN • 英文原文

> The scenario is right out of a Stephen King novel: At a medical lab stashed away in a remote Siberian city, a pretty young technician was exposed to a deadly pathogen. She died, the lab went into lockdown, and soon rumors emerged that the Russian security services were on the scene. Now the world waits to see whether some monstrous microbe is going to make its way out of Russia’s forests.

ZH • 中文译文

这个场景简直就像斯蒂芬·金的小说情节：在西伯利亚一个偏远城市藏匿的一间医学实验室里，一名年轻貌美的技术人员接触到了致命病原体。她不幸身亡，实验室随即进入封锁状态，很快便有传言称俄罗斯安全部门已赶到现场。如今，全世界都在等待，看看是否会有某种可怕的微生物从俄罗斯的森林中蔓延出来。

第 2 段 / Paragraph 2

EN • 英文原文

What's going on in Russia is bad, but—at least so far—not *that* bad. We know that someone working at a research institute that studies various forms of plague has died of pneumonia, which suggests that she mishandled a sample of pneumonic plague. That's about it. Medical observers are rightly concerned: Pneumonic plague is nasty stuff. But it's also not some unknown bug; a few hundred cases appear every year, and it is easily cured with antibiotics if diagnosed quickly enough. Counterintuitively, the pathogen's deadliness limits the disease's ability to spread: It kills its victims before they can infect too many other people. (ln this case, the remote location of the Russian facility might also help to contain any outbreak.)

ZH • 中文译文

俄罗斯目前的情况确实不妙，但——至少到目前为止——还远没有糟糕到那种地步。我们知道，某家研究各种形式瘟疫的研究所里，有一名工作人员因肺炎去世，这表明她可能不当处理了肺鼠疫样本。情况大致如此。医疗观察人士对此表示担忧不无道理：肺鼠疫是一种可怕的疾病。但它也并非什么未知病原体；全球每年会出现数百例病例，只要诊断及时，用抗生素就能轻松治愈。出人意料的是，这种病原体的致命性反而限制了疾病的传播能力：它在患者感染太多其他人之前，就将患者致死。（就本案而言，俄罗斯该研究设施地处偏远，或许也有助于控制任何可能爆发的疫情。）

第 3 段 / Paragraph 3

EN • 英文原文

Nevertheless, the situation in Siberia raises unsettling questions, and international experts, along with U.S. diplomats, are asking for more transparency. What kind of experiments are being conducted at this lab—the Irkutsk Anti-Plague Research Institute of Siberia and the Far East—and are they possibly related to biological warfare? Did the researcher die of a known variant of the pneumonic plague, or some new, deadlier strain? Why are the Russian authorities reportedly quarantining hundreds of people?

ZH • 中文译文

然而，西伯利亚的局势引发了令人不安的疑问，国际专家与美国外交官正要求当局提高透明度。这家名为“西伯利亚与远东伊尔库茨克鼠疫研究所”的实验室究竟在进行何种实验？这些实验是否与生物战有关？那名研究人员究竟是死于已知的肺鼠疫变种，还是某种新型、更具致命性的菌株？此外，据称俄罗斯当局为何要对数百人实施隔离？

第 4 段 / Paragraph 4

EN • 英文原文

Don’t expect honest answers from the Russians about any of this. The main source of information about this incident has been Russia’s Federal Service for the Oversight of Consumer Protection and Welfare, known by an abbreviation, Rospotrebnadzor (“ras-pah-treb-nah-dzor”). The name is rather anodyne, but the many duties of this organization include supervision of some of Russia’s biological-research institutes. For years it was part of the Russian ministry of health, but in 2012 it was reassigned and now reports directly to the Russian central government, elevating its importance and its broader mandate to act as Russia’s main overseer of epidemiological research.

ZH • 中文译文

别指望俄罗斯人会就此事给出任何诚实的回答。关于这起事件的主要信息来源，是俄罗斯联邦消费者权益保护和福利监督局，其缩写为Rospotrebnadzor（“拉斯-波特列布-纳佐尔”）。这个名称听起来相当平淡无奇，但该机构的职责众多，其中包括对俄罗斯部分生物研究机构进行监督。多年来，它一直是俄罗斯卫生部的一部分，但在2012年被重新划归，如今直接向俄罗斯中央政府汇报，从而提升了其地位，并扩大了其作为俄罗斯流行病学研究主要监管机构的权限。

第 5 段 / Paragraph 5

EN • 英文原文

Not that Rospotrebnadzor has been all that helpful in making sense of the crisis in Irkutsk. Regarding the death of Darya Shipilova, the lab worker, for example, it said: “No micro-organisms associated with the employee’s professional duties were detected in samples taken from the patient,” a careful construction that says almost nothing. What were the employee’s professional duties? What organisms *were* detected? Shipilova died of *something*; what was it?

ZH • 中文译文

倒不是说俄罗斯联邦消费者权益保护和公益监督局在帮助人们理解伊尔库茨克的危机方面提供了多大帮助。例如，关于实验室工作人员达里娅·希皮洛娃之死，该机构表示：“从患者身上采集的样本中，并未检测到与该员工职业职责相关的任何微生物。”这种措辞十分谨慎，几乎什么信息都没透露。该员工的职业职责究竟是什么？到底检测出了哪些微生物？希皮洛娃是死于“某种东西”的，那究竟是什么？

第 6 段 / Paragraph 6

EN · 英文原文

Rospotrebnadzor said in an official statement that the woman died of “pneumonia of unknown cause,” but the region’s governor, Igor Kobzev, might have let the cat out of the bag when he revealed that Anna Popova, the head of Rospotrebnadzor, traveled to Irkutsk last week. CNN reports that Kobzev posted on Telegram that she came to town for an “extraordinary meeting of the regional sanitary and anti-epidemic commission,” in connection with “a suspected case of a regional resident with a particularly dangerous infection.”

ZH · 中文译文

俄罗斯联邦消费者权益保护和公益监督局在一份官方声明中表示，该女子死于“原因不明的肺炎”，但该州州长伊戈尔·科布泽夫可能无意中泄露了天机，他透露俄罗斯联邦消费者权益保护和公益监督局局长安娜·波波娃已于上周前往伊尔库茨克。CNN报道称，科布泽夫在Telegram上发帖称，她前来该市是为了召开“地区卫生与防疫委员会的特别会议”，而此次会议与“一名地区居民疑似感染一种特别危险的传染病”有关。

第 7 段 / Paragraph 7

EN · 英文原文

A U.S. State Department spokesperson over the weekend encouraged “Russian authorities to share accurate information quickly and openly.” Good luck with that. The Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov closed the noninformation loop with this helpful advice: “The lead agency with expertise in this area is Rospotrebnadzor. People should rely on its official statements and disregard rumors, speculation, and so on.”

ZH • 中文译文

美国国务院的一位发言人上周末敦促“俄罗斯当局迅速、公开地分享准确信息”。祝你好运。克里姆林宫发言人德米特里·佩斯科夫则用这条“贴心建议”彻底堵上了信息沟通的大门：“负责该领域的牵头机构是俄罗斯联邦消费者权益保护和公益监督局。民众应以其官方声明为准，不要理会各种谣言、猜测等。”

第 8 段 / Paragraph 8

EN • 英文原文

One innocent explanation is that the Irkutsk institute is trying to come up with better ways to prevent plague, and someone mishandled dangerous material—and the Russians, with their mania for secrecy, are making it all seem more ominous than necessary by clamping down on any further information. But maybe something more ominous is, in fact, going on. Dr. Ashish Jha, the former dean of Brown University’s school of public health and a former member of the Biden administration’s COVID-response team, pointed out in a thread on X on Sunday that “Russia is well known to have an active military biological weapons program.” He additionally noted reports (so far unconfirmed) that units of the Russian security services have been escorting vehicles to local hospitals.

ZH • 中文译文

一种合理的解释是，伊尔库茨克的这家机构正在尝试寻找更好的方法来预防瘟疫，而有人不慎处理了危险物质——俄罗斯方面出于对保密的狂热，通过压制任何进一步的信息，使得整个事件听起来比实际情况更加不祥。但或许，确实有更不寻常的事情正在发生。布朗大学公共卫生学院前院长、拜登政府新冠疫情应对小组前成员阿希什·贾博士（Dr. Ashish Jha）周日在X上的一条推文中指出：“众所周知，俄罗斯有一个活跃的军事生物武器计划。”他还提到一些报道（目前尚未得到证实），称俄罗斯安全部门的单位一直在护送车辆前往当地医院。

第 9 段 / Paragraph 9

EN • 英文原文

Moscow has a long history with biological-weapons research going back to the Cold War. The United States unilaterally renounced research into biological-warfare agents back in 1969; the Soviets signed the 1972 Biological Weapons Convention, but in reality they never abandoned such programs. The Russians claimed in 1992 to have ended those efforts, but they are currently expanding a sizable facility that had once been used for biological-warfare research. (The Russian Ministry of Defense, predictably, has no comment on these construction activities.)

ZH • 中文译文

莫斯科在生物武器研究方面有着悠久的历史，其历史可追溯至冷战时期。早在1969年，美国就单方面放弃了生物战剂的研究；而苏联虽然签署了《1972年生物武器公约》（1972 Biological Weapons Convention），但实际上从未放弃过相关项目。俄罗斯方面声称已于1992年终止了这些工作，但目前他们正在扩建一处大型设施，而该设施过去曾被用于生物战研究。（不出所料，俄罗斯国防部对这些建设活动未置一词。）

第 10 段 / Paragraph 10

EN • 英文原文

If the Irkutsk incident turns out to be the result of an accident in a Russian biological-warfare lab, it won't be the first time. Back in 1979, the Soviet Union tried desperately to cover up an outbreak of anthrax in a city near the Ural Mountains, Sverdlovsk (now called Yekaterinburg). They nearly got away with it.

ZH • 中文译文

如果伊尔库茨克事件最终被证实是俄罗斯生物武器实验室发生事故的后果，那这也不是第一次了。早在1979年，苏联曾竭力掩盖乌拉尔山脉附近一座城市——斯维尔德洛夫斯克（现称叶卡捷琳堡）——发生炭疽热疫情一事。他们差一点就瞒天过海了。

第 11 段 / Paragraph 11

EN • 英文原文

In the fall of 1979 and early 1980, a Russian-language émigré newspaper based in what was then West Germany ran reports about some kind of germ-related disaster in the Urals after an explosion at a lab. Evidence that dribbled in from Sverdlovsk over time, including the fact that the Soviet minister of defense personally visited the city, suggested that something big had indeed gone down. Descriptions of the illness spreading through the area pointed to anthrax, and in the early ’80s, the Americans—this was during the Cold War, after all—loudly accused the Soviets of working on an anthrax weapon.

ZH • 中文译文

1979年秋季至1980年初，一家总部位于当时西德语的俄语侨民报纸刊登了报道，称乌拉尔地区一处实验室发生爆炸后，出现了一起与病菌相关的灾难。此后，来自斯维尔德洛夫斯克的消息零星传出，包括苏联国防部长亲自到访该市等事实，都表明那里确实发生了重大事件。关于该地区蔓延的病症描述指向了炭疽病。到了20世纪80年代初，美国人——毕竟当时正值冷战期间——大声指责苏联正在研制炭疽武器。

第 12 段 / Paragraph 12

EN • 英文原文

The Soviets pretended to be deeply offended at such an accusation, and explained that the deaths and illnesses were the result of people eating tainted meat—it was all just a simple case of food poisoning. (After all, what nation doesn’t blockade roads in a major city and send their military chief to check on some locals eating bad beef?) The Soviet explanation was hooey, of course; a defector who worked in Soviet bioweapons programs, Ken Alibek, later theorized that the lab in Sverdlovsk making the anthrax had neglected to replace a filter and had ended up venting spores into the area.

ZH • 中文译文

苏联方面假装对这样的指控深感冒犯，并解释说，那些死亡和疾病都是人们食用了受污染的肉类所致——这不过是一起简单的食物中毒事件罢了。（毕竟，哪个国家会在一个大城市封锁道路，还派军事首脑去调查当地居民食用劣质牛肉的事情呢？）当然，苏联的解释纯属无稽之谈；曾在苏联生物武器项目工作的叛逃者肯·阿里贝克后来推测，斯维尔德洛夫斯克制造炭疽杆菌的实验室因疏于更换过滤器，最终导致孢子泄漏到了周边地区。

第 13 段 / Paragraph 13

EN • 英文原文

Thirteen years would pass after the outbreak before anyone in Moscow admitted the truth. In 1992, then–Russian President Boris Yeltsin told the Americans that Soviet biowarfare experts had indeed been doing anthrax research, and that these experts had repeatedly lied to him about the 1979 event. The official death toll from the Sverdlovsk accident stands at 68, but no one will ever know the true numbers: The KGB at the time immediately seized and destroyed important evidence, including medical records. One might think the Soviets were chastened by this experience, but one would be wrong: After the Sverdlovsk facility was closed, the Soviets built another one in Kazakhstan, where they reportedly worked on strains of anthrax even more virulent than the stuff released in Sverdlovsk.

ZH • 中文译文

直到13年后，莫斯科才有人承认真相。1992年，时任俄罗斯总统鲍里斯·叶利钦告诉美国人，苏联的生物战专家确实在研究炭疽，而且这些专家就1979年的事件对他撒了谎。斯维尔德洛夫斯克事故的官方死亡人数为68人，但真实数字将永远无人知晓：当时克格勃立即没收并销毁了包括医疗记录在内的重要证据。人们或许会认为苏联人从这次经历中吸取了教训，但事实并非如此：斯维尔德洛夫斯克设施关闭后，苏联又在哈萨克斯坦建造了另一处设施，据称他们在那里研究的炭疽菌株比在斯维尔德洛夫斯克释放的菌株毒性还要强。

第 14 段 / Paragraph 14

EN • 英文原文

If something terrible has happened in Irkutsk, don’t count on the Russians coming clean about it anytime soon. Russia is led by an aggressive dictator who has been making war in Europe for four years, and Moscow’s incomplete explanations about what’s happening in Siberia cannot be trusted. The possibility that the Russians are working on existentially dangerous biological weapons is one more challenge to American—and global—security.

ZH • 中文译文

如果伊尔库茨克发生了可怕的事情，不要指望俄罗斯人会很快坦白。俄罗斯由一位好战的独裁者领导，他已在欧洲发动战争长达四年之久，而莫斯科对西伯利亚所发生事件的片面解释并不可信。俄罗斯人正在研发具有生存威胁的生物武器，这种可能性给美国乃至全球安全带来了又一重挑战。